

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

votes. By this time, however, she had come to the high command's notice, given her involvement in Rahul Gandhi's Bharat Jodo Yatra and Priyanka Gandhi's 'Ladki hoon, lad sakti hoon' campaign. She did not belie her party's hope, defeating BJP heavyweight Ram Swarup Kohli. Her priority now is to take up the demand for OBC status for the Jats of Bharatpur-Dholpur who have been denied the same due to the community's royal roots.

▶ SAGAR ESHWAR KHANDRE, *26*

| CONGRESS | ***Bidar, Karnataka***



Grandson of the centenarian Bheemanna Khandre and son of current state environment minister Eshwar Khandre, Sagar comes armed with strong political genes. The law and BBA graduate found himself getting actively involved in social work in his father's assembly constituency Bhalki, when Khandre Sr was in hospital with Covid. This year, he locked horns with the BJP's Bhagwanth Khuba, who had held the Bidar Lok Sabha seat for the past 10 years. Khuba had, in fact, defeated Sagar's father in 2019 from Bidar. The victory is therefore that much sweeter for Sagar, who wrested the seat that had eluded his father in his maiden electoral outing.

▼ PRIYANKA SATISH JARKIHOLI, *27*

| CONGRESS | ***Chikkodi, Karnataka***

Priyanka is not only among the youngest parliamentarians this time, she is also the first tribal woman to win from an unreserved Lok Sabha seat. An MBA grad from the Visvesvaraya Technological University, she is a scion of Belagavi's powerful Jarkiholi family, which owns sugar mills and other businesses in the district and belongs to the Valmiki Nayak Scheduled Tribe community. Politics is a natural career for her given that her father, Satish Jarkiholi, is the PWD minister in the Siddaramaiah-led Congress government in the state, and two of her uncles—Ramesh and Balachandra Jarkiholi—are BJP legislators. Priyanka was the only Congress nominee to have won against a BJP candidate in the saffron-leaning Kittur Karnataka region, defeating the incumbent MP Annasaheb Jolle by a margin of 90,834 votes.

